



The Older Sandwich Generation Across European Welfare Regimes: Demographic and Social Considerations

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Population Aging and Intergenerational Relationship
Thiago Cordeiro-Almeida
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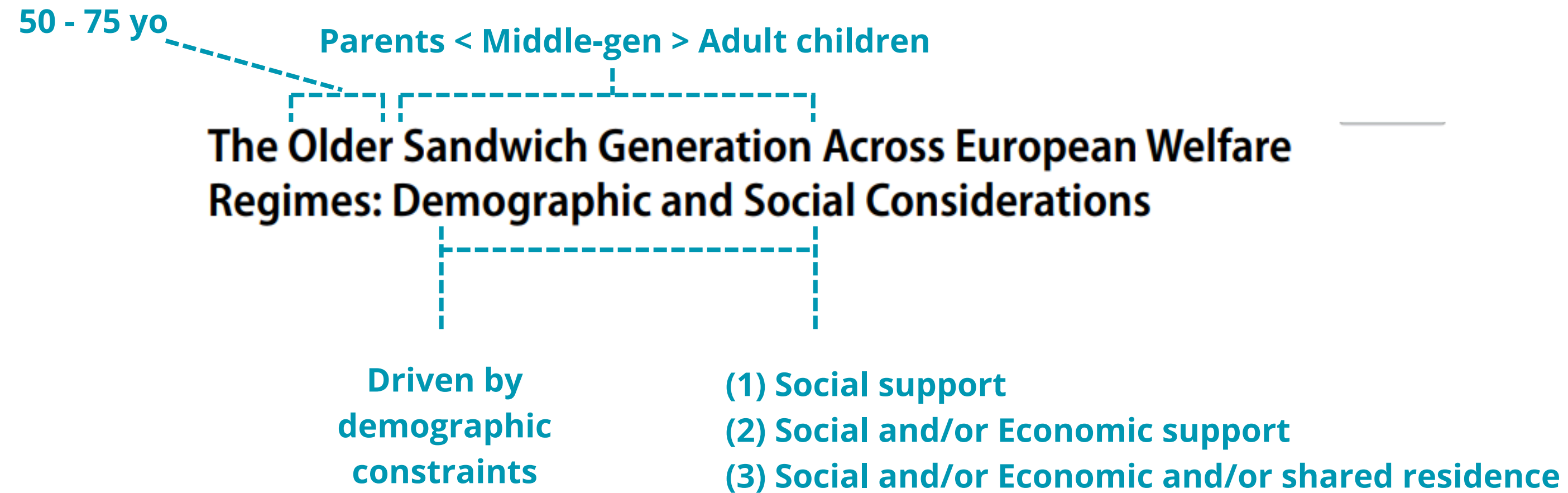
Concepts

50 - 75 yo

Parents < Middle-gen > Adult children

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Regimes: Demographic and Social Considerations**

Concepts

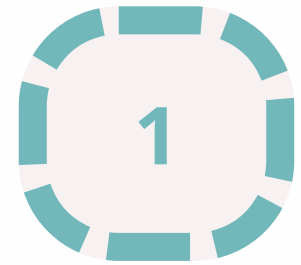


Motivation

Literature gap

- Little evidence about the older Sandwich Generation (SG).
- Previous studies focused on informal care as the main social support.
- Welfare states as a potential source of heterogeneity in the family support and demographic regimes.

Objectives



Estimates the prevalence of demographic and social sandwiching and evaluate whether estimates are sensitive to the type of support considered.

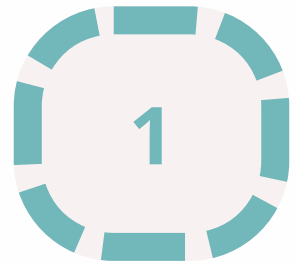


Describe whether the prevalence of social sandwiching is associated with welfare and transfer regimes.

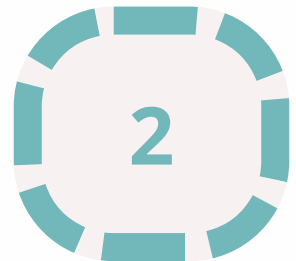


Transitions in and out of being social sandwiched to identify the most common sequences.

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Prevalences

Around 2% were demog. sandwiched in social support, and around 8% in social, economic and residential.

Among the demographic SG:

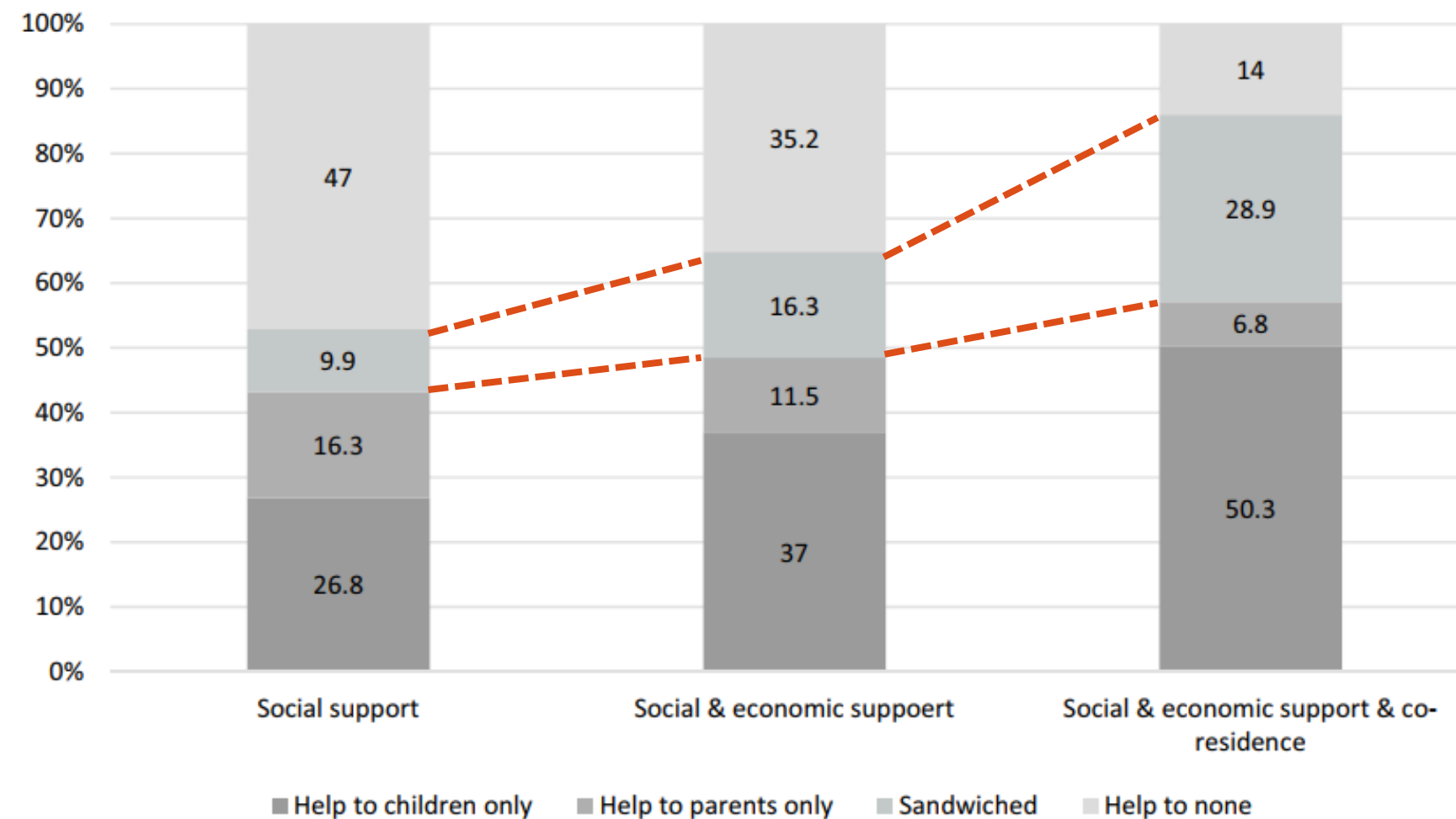


Fig. 1 Distribution of different states, among individuals who are demographically sandwiched—by three different definitions of intergenerational support. (*Source*: Own calculations on SHARE wave 6 data, weighted results)

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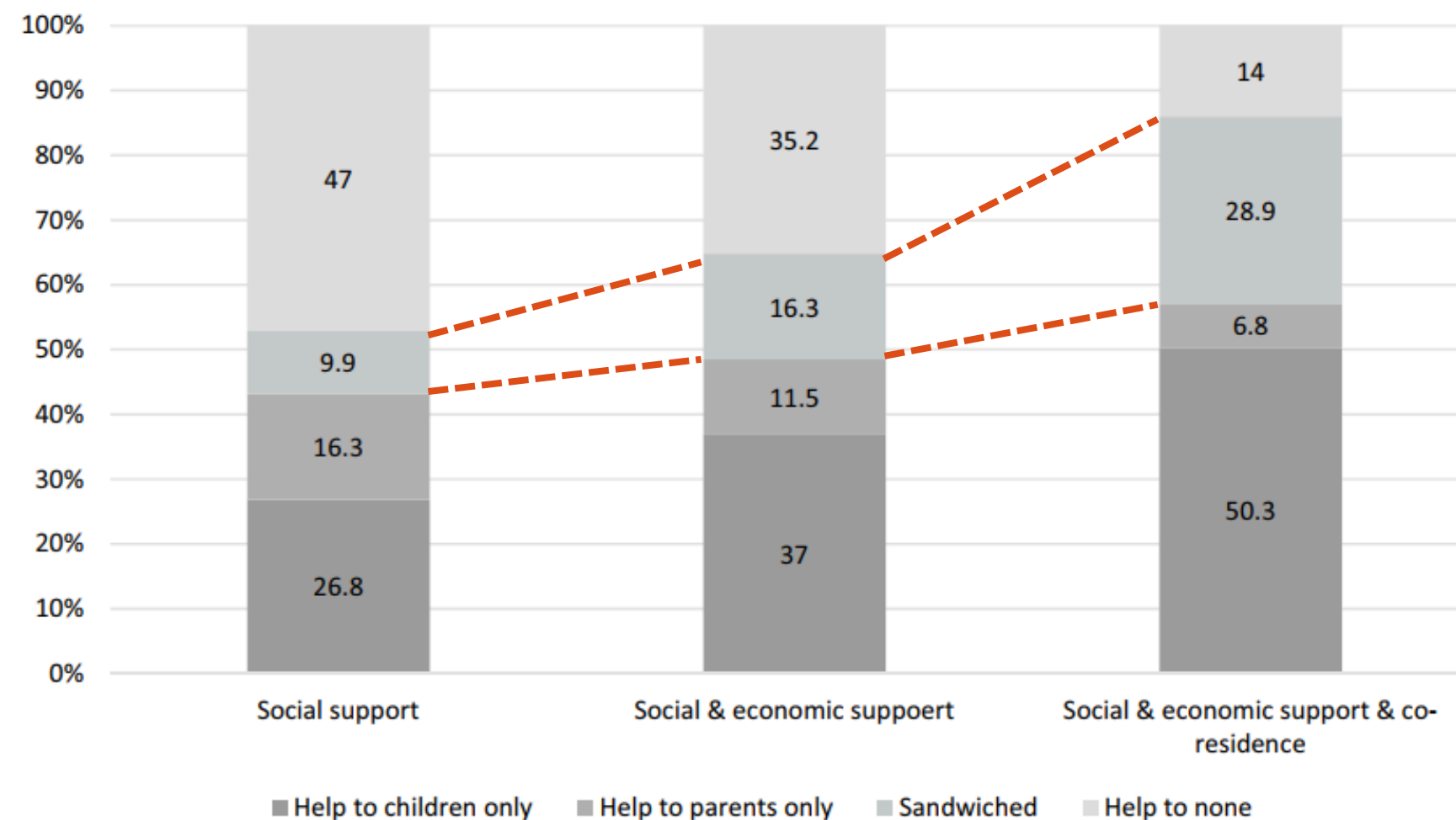


Fig. 1 Distribution of different states, among individuals who are demographically sandwiched—by three different definitions of intergenerational support. (*Source:* Own calculations on SHARE wave 6 data, weighted results)

Prevalence increases in more comprehensive definitions of socially sandwiching.

- **Nordic countries** show the highest rates of social sandwiching.
- **Southern Europe** appears lower initially...
- ... BUT differences shrink when co-residence is included

Thank you!
Obrigado!
Merci!

Thiago Cordeiro-Almeida

Main take-aways

Social sandwiching is highly sensitive to the type of support used to operationalize the concept.

Focusing on more restrictive definitions excludes a sizable portion of the demographically sandwiched who support both gen.

Differences across welfare regimes can reflect demographic and cultural variations in their behaviours.